MILITARY SPECIFICATION

SUTURE REMOVAL KIT, DISPOSABLE, STERILE

This specification is approved for use by all Departments and Agencies of the Department of Defense.

1. SCOPE

1.1 Scope. This specification covers a sterile, disposable, suture removal kit suitable for removal of sutures.

2. APPLICABLE DOCUMENTS

2.1 The following documents of the issue in effect on date of invitation for bids or request for proposals, form a part of the specification to the extent specified herein:

SPECIFICATIONS

Federal

MMM-A-250	Adhesive, Water Resistant (for Sealing Fiberboard Boxes).
PPP-B-585	Boxes, Wood, Wirebound.
PPP-B-601	Boxes, Wood, Cleated-plywood.
PPP-B-621	Boxes, Wood, Nailed and Lock-Corner.
PPP-B-636	Box, Fiberboard.
PPP-T-76	Tape, Pressure-Sensitive Adhesive Paper, for Carton Sealing).

Military

MIL-S-36586	Sterilization Strip Test, Bacterial Spore.

FSC 6515

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STANDARDS

Military

MIL-STD-105	Sampling Procedures and Tables for Inspection by Attributes.
MIL-STD-129	Marking for Shipment and Storage.

DRAWING

Defense Personnel Support Center (DPSC)

24145	Suture Removal Kit, Disposable, Sterile, 50s

(Copies of specifications, standards and drawing required by suppliers in connection with specific procurement functions should be obtained from the procuring activity or as directed by the contracting officer.)

2.2 Other publications. The following documents form a part of this specification to the extent specified herein. Unless otherwise indicated, the issue in effect on date of invitation for bids or request for proposals shall apply:

U.S. PHARMACOPEIAL CONVENTION, INC.

Pharmacopeia of the United States (U.S.P.)

(Application for copies should be addressed to the Mack Publishing Company, Easton, Pa. 18042.)

U. S. DEPARTMENT OF HEALTH, EDUCATION AND WELFARE

Federal, Food, Drug and Cosmetic Act (FDA) and Regulations Promulgated thereunder.

(Applications for copies should be addressed to the Food and Drug Administration, Washington, D.C. 20204).

3. REQUIREMENTS

3.1 Material. The material used shall be as indicated herein and of high quality, suitable in all respects for the purpose intended. Metal forceps and scissors shall be stainless steel or nickel plated carbon steel. Cutting edges shall not be nickel plated. Gauze pad shall be fabricated from materials specified in strict accordance with the requirements specified in Defense Medical Purchase Description covering Federal Stock Number 6510-074-4579 SPONGE, SURGICAL, Post-Operative, 4 by 4 inches. The issue in effect during invitation for bids or request for proposals shall apply concerning the above Defense Medical Purchase Description. Overwrap shall be paper towel type sheet.

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3.2 Style, design and dimensions. Shall be a sterile, disposable, suture removal kit, consisting of a gauze pad, metal forceps, and metal scissors, overwrapped in a paper towel type sheet. Kit shall be suitable for the removal of sutures. The metal scissors shall be approximately 4-1/2 inches long, and have one scalloped or sharp point, and one blunt point. The metal forceps shall be approximately 4-1/2 inches long with precisely meeting tips suitable for removal of sutures. The gauze pad shall be in strict accordance with Defense Medical Purchase Description covering 6510-074-4379 as specified in 3.1. Shall be in accordance with Figure 1.

3.3 Sterility. The suture removal kit shall be sterile when tested with a biological indicator as specified in 4.4.1.

3.3.1 Certificate of sterility. A certificate of sterility, stating that samples from each sterilizer lot have been tested and found to be sterile, shall be submitted to the procuring activity. The certificate of sterility shall include:

a. Item Identification.
b. Federal stock number.
c. Contract or purchase order number.
d. Sterility lot or control number.
e. Date of sterilization.
f. Quantity of product in sterilizer lot.
g. Type of sterilization (gas, radiation, heat, steam, etc.).
h. Form of biological indicator (i.e., inoculated simulated product.)
i. Test organism(s) and population density used.
j. Test medium, incubation temperature, incubation time, and dates of tests.
k. Number of test units.
l. Statement that samples comply with sterility tests.
m. Signature of head of laboratory or a designated qualified alternate.

When inspection is made at destination, the certificate of sterility shall be submitted by the contractor to the Directorate of Medical Materiel, ATTN: DPSC-ATQ, Defense Personnel Support Center, 2800 South 20th Street, Philadelphia, Pa., 19101, and a copy forwarded with each shipment to the consignee. When inspection is made at source, certificate of sterility shall be furnished to the cognizant Government Quality Assurance Representative for submission to the procuring activity.

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3.3.2 Sterility lot. A sterility lot is that single quantity of product subjected to the same manufacturing operation and simultaneously sterilized in the same sterilizer chamber. Each unit package shall be clearly marked with a sterility lot (control) number and date of sterilization as specified in 5.3.1. Each sterility lot shall be traceable to the pertinent manufacturing lot(s).

3.4 Scissors performance. On the first closing of the blades, the scissors shall be capable of cutting the following types and sizes of sutures, when tested as specified in 4.4.2: plain gut sizes 4-0, 3-0, 2-0, 1-0; chromic gut sizes 4-0, 3-0, 2-0, 1-0, 1; braided silk sizes 4-0, 3-0, 2-0, 1-0, and stainless steel wire size 3-0. Each scissors tested shall cut once. A different scissors shall be used to cut each type and size of suture specified above.

3.5 Workmanship. Workmanship shall be first class throughout. Kits shall be free from defects which detract from their appearance or may impair their serviceability.

4. QUALITY ASSURANCE PROVISIONS

4.1 Responsibility for inspection. Unless otherwise specified in the contract or purchase order, the supplier is responsible for the performance of all inspection requirements as specified herein. Except as otherwise specified in the contract or order, the supplier may use his own or any other facilities suitable for the performance of the inspection requirements specified herein, unless disapproved by the Government. The Government reserves the right to perform any of the inspections set forth in the specification where such inspections are deemed necessary to assure supplies and services conform to prescribed requirements.

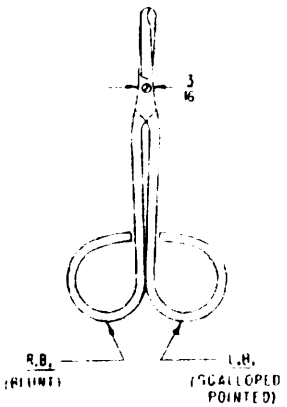
4.1.1 Records. Records of examinations and tests performed by or for the contractor shall be maintained by the contractor and made available to the Government, upon the Government's request, at any time, or from time to time, during the performance of the contract and for a period of 3 years after delivery of the supplies to which such records relate.

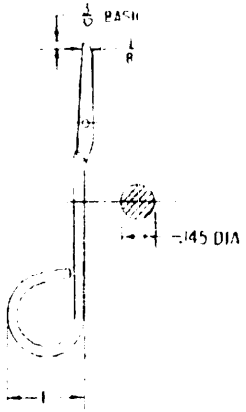
4.1.2 Inspection. Inspection, as used in this specification, is defined as both examination (such as visual or auditory investigation without the use of special laboratory appliances of procedures) and testing (determination by technical means of physical and chemical properties) of the item.

4.2 Sampling.

4.2.1 For examination. Sampling for examination shall be conducted in accordance with MIL-STD-105 and as indicated in Table I.

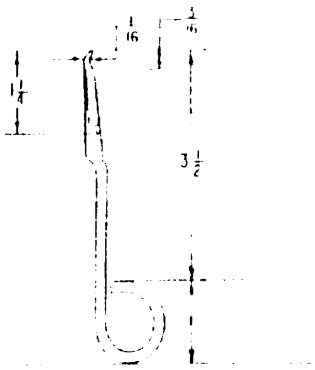
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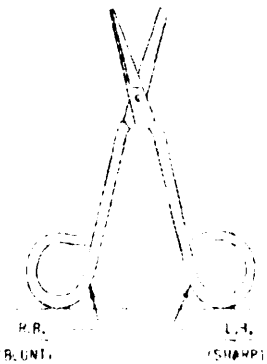
RIGHT BLADE (BLUNT)

ALL OTHER DIMENSIONS
SAME AS LEFT BLADE

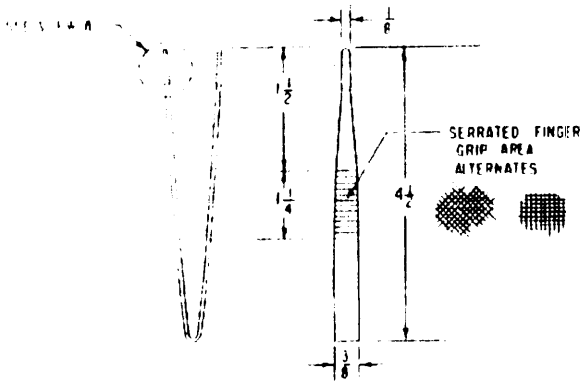


LEFT BLADE SCALLOPED
POINTED

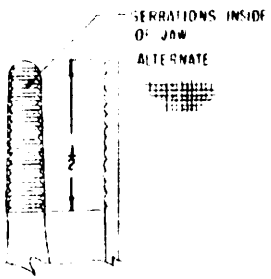
ALL OTHER DIMENSIONS
SAME AS RIGHT BLADE



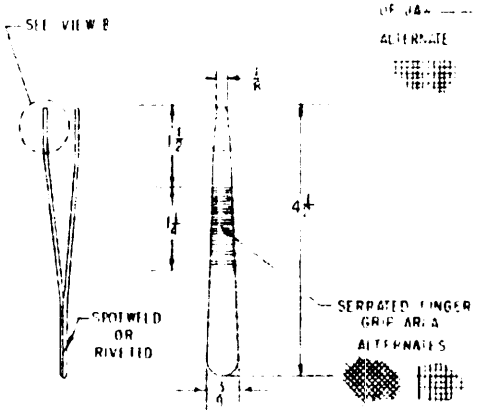
ALTERNATE



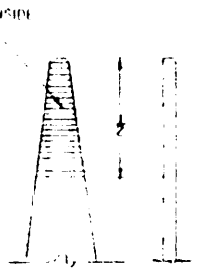
SUTURE FORCEPS
METAL



VIEW A



ALTERNATE
SUTURE FORCEPS
METAL



VIEW B

MIL-S-3●957

FIGURE 1

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Table I. Sampling for Examination

Type defect	Unit of product	Inspection level	AQL (percent defective)
Major A	Kit	I	1.0
Major B	Component	I	1.0
Minor	Component	I	2.5

4.2.2 For tests. Sampling for tests shall be conducted in accordance with MIL-STD-105 and as indicated in Table II.

Table II. Sampling for Tests

Unit of product	Characteristic	Requirement	Test procedure	Inspection level	AQL (percent defective
Kit	Sterility	3.3	4.4.1	**	*
Scissors	Performance	3.4	4.4.2	S-4	2.5

* Acceptance number shall be zero for all sample sizes.
** Sampling for sterility testing shall be as specified in the U.S.P. for non-parenteral devices.

4.2.3 Sample unit usage. Where feasible, the same sample unit shall be used for the determination of two or more test characteristics.

4.3 Examination. The kits shall be examined to determine compliance with all requirements contained in this specification. Examination shall be conducted in accordance with MIL-STD-105 and the following classification of defects. Examination shall include, but shall not be limited to, the classified possible defects listed in Table III.

Table III. Classification of Defects

Categories	Defects
Critical	None defined.
Major A	
101	Kit incomplete; one or more components missing.
Major B	
151	Metal parts not smoothly finished; not free of rough edges, slivers, nicks, pits, blisters, scratches, cracks, roughness, or corrosion, as applicable.
152	Style and design of components not as specified.
153	Inside jaw of forceps not serrated.
154	Tips of scissors bent.

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Table III. Classification of Defects (con't)

Categories	Defects
Minor	
201	Surface debris on any component.
202	Action of closing and opening scissors not smooth and uninterrupted.
203	Cutting edge of blunt-tipped blade extends beyond the back of the opposing blade - when scissors are in closed position.

4.4 Tests. Tests shall be conducted to determine compliance with specification requirements.

4.4.1 Sterility test. The suture removal kit components shall be tested for sterility in accordance with the method specified in the USP for purified cotton, gauze, surgical dressings and related material and method for non-parenteral devices, as applicable, using inoculated product, inoculated simulated product, or paper spore strip (carrier). Product containing biological indicator shall be marked or labeled so that it clearly differentiates from product intended for distribution. The incubation medium and minimum time in each case shall be soybean casein digest for 7 days inoculated product, inoculated simulated product, or paper spore strip (carrier). The incubation temperature shall be as indicated in paragraph 4.4.1.1. The minimum number of test units, regardless of lot size, shall be 10, except for inoculated carrier which shall be 20 for Type I Sterilization and 30 for Type II Sterilization including inoculated carrier and product test units. The inspection level shall be as indicated in Table II, Sampling Criteria for Tests.

4.4.1.1 Inoculated product or simlulated product. For each type of sterilization, the organism used shall be as listed below:

Type of Sterilization	Organism	Incubation Temperature
Steam	B. stearothermophilus	55° - 65°C
Dry Heat	B. stearothermophilus or	55° - 65°C
	B. subtilis var. niger (or globigii)	30° - 35°C
Gas	B. subtilis var. niger (or globigii)	30° - 35°C
Radiation	B. pumilus	30° - 35°C

The number of viable cells shall be sufficient to provide assurance that the product has been sterilized.

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4.4.1.2 Inoculated carrier. Inoculated carriers (paper spore strips) if used shall be in accordance with MIL-S-36586. Other paper carriers shall be inoculated to be of equivalent resistance. The method of incubation and number of test units shall be as indicated in 4.4.1 Sterility test and 4.4.1.1 Inoculated product or simulated product. The method of sterilization will control the organism in the spore strip to be tested for as shown in 4.4.1.1. NOTE: When an inoculated carrier is chosen, product samples must also be tested as required by the USP.

4.4.1.3 Alternate method. Suppliers conducting sterility tests or designating lots in a manner other than that indicated herein shall submit proof that the alternate method provides equal assurance concerning the sterility of the product. However, all sterility tests shall be conducted using biological indicators. Requests for approval of any alternate method of testing for sterility shall be made to the Contracting Officer, and approval obtained before employment of the alternate method on a government contract.

4.4.2 Scissors performance test. The strand of suture to be cut with scissors shall be held at one end, with thumb and forefinger, in vertical position. Tension shall be applied to suture by securing 25.0 gram weight to other end. Scissors shall be perpendicular to suture when in cutting position. If sharp blade of scissors has scallop, suture to be cut shall be placed in scallop. If sharp blade of scissors does not have scallop, suture to be cut shall be placed on blade approximately 1/8 inch from point of blade.

5. PREPARATION FOR DELIVERY

5.1 Packaging.

5.1.1 Unit of issue. One package containing fifty suture removal kits, as specified, constitutes one unit of issue.

5.1.2 Packaging quantities. The number of units of issue indicated in Table IV shall be packaged in each unit and exterior container, as applicable, for the required level of protection specified in the procurement document.

Table IV. Packaging Quantities

Unit package	Intermediate package	Exterior container
1 unit	Not Required	4 units

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5.1.2.1 Packing variation permitted. If the required number of units in the entire shipment is less than the number of units specified to be overpacked in an exterior container, such units may be packed in an exterior container of suitable size and design, acceptable to a common carrier, which shall insure safe delivery to destination.

5.1.3 Level A.

5.1.3.1 Immediate container. The scissors, forceps, and gauze pad shall be wrapped in a paper towel type sheet and packaged in a sealed peel-open type container of appropriate size. The container shall be capable of maintaining sterility of contents unless damaged or opened. The container shall be designed with tabs to facilitate opening and dispensing of contents.

5.1.3.2 Unit package. Unit package shall be a box of appropriate size and design constructed in accordance with PPP-B-636, type CF, class weather-resistant. Boxes shall be closed by taping the top and bottom flaps with 2 inch wide tape conforming to PPP-&-76. Closing of bottom flaps with adhesive conforming to MMM-A-250 or metal stitches is permitted.

5.1.4 Level C. Units shall be packaged in standard commercial containers of the size and kind commonly used, which will afford the degree of protection required for shipment and use of the product for its intended purpose.

5.2 Packing.

5.2.1 Level A.

5.2.1.1 Exterior container. Exterior container shall be designed for a type 2 load and constructed in accordance with PPP-B-585, class 3, style 3; PPP-B-601, overseas type; PPP-B-621, class 2; or PPP-B-636, class weather-resistant resistant, grade V3c. Closure and strapping shall be as specified in the appendix of the applicable box specification. Special requirements of applicable table shall apply for PPP-B-636 box.

5.2.2 Level B.

5.2.2.1 Exterior container. Exterior container shall be designed for a type 2 load and constructed in accordance with PPP-B-585, class 1, style 3; PPP-B-601, domestic type; PPP-B-621, class 1; or PPP-B-636, class domestic. Closure shall be as specified in the appendix of the applicable box specification. Fiberboard box shall be closed by method II of PPP-B-636. Special requirements of applicable table shall apply for PPP-B-636 box.

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5.2.3 Level C. The subject commodity shall be packed in substantial commercial containers of the type, size, and kind commonly used for the purpose, so constructed as to insure acceptance and safe delivery by common or other carriers, at the lowest rate, to point of delivery called for in the contract or purchase order.

5.3 Marking.

5.3.1 Immediate container. In addition to any commercial markings, each immediate container shall be marked in accordance with the requirements of the Federal Food, Drug, and Cosmetic Act. In addition, marking shall include the item identification, lot (control) number, and the legends: "STERILE" and "STERILITY GUARANTEED UNLESS PACKAGE IS DAMAGED OR OPENED".

5.3.2 Unit package. Each unit package shall be marked in accordance with MIL-STD-129. Lot (control) number name and address of the manufacturer, and the method of sterilization (G-Gas, R-Radiation, C-Cold, S-Steam, D-Dry Heat Sterilization) shall be shown following the level of packaging and date of packaging. Example: "A-9/69-G."

5.3.3 Exterior container. Exterior container shall be marked in accordance with MIL-STD-129. Lot (control) number and the method of sterilization, as specified in 5.3.2, shall be shown.

NOTE: Final sterilization shall be on or after indicated packaging date.

6. NOTES

6.1 Intended use. The suture removal kit are intended for removing sutures after surgery.

6.2 Ordering data. Purchasers should exercise any desired options offered herein, and the procurement documents should specify the following:

(a) Title, number, and date of this specification.
(b) Selection of applicable levels of packaging and packing (see 5.1 and 5.2).

6.3 This specification is intended to cover the following item appearing in the Federal Supply Catalog:

Federal Stock No.	Item Identification
6515-436-1881	**SUTURE REMOVAL KIT, Disposable,** Sterile, 50s.

It does not include all types or sizes as indicated by the title nor all types which are commercially available.

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6.4 Supersession data. This specification includes requirements of Defense Medical Purchase Description No. 4, dated 22 July 1971 and Modification No. 1 dated 29 November 1972 for FSN 6515-436-1881, SUTURE REMOVAL KIT, Disposable, Sterile, 50s.

Custodians:
Army - MD
Navy - MS
Air Force - 03

Preparing activity:
Defense Supply Agency - DM

Project No. 6515-1710

Review activities:
Army - MD
Navy - MS
Air Force - 03

Review information is current as of the date of this document. For future coordination of changes to this document, draft circulation should be based on the information in the current DODISS.

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STANDARDIZATION DOCUMENT IMPROVEMENT PROPOSAL

OMB Approval No. 22-R255

INSTRUCTIONS. The purpose of this form is to solicit beneficial comments which will help achieve procurement of suitable products at reasonable cost and minimum delay, or will otherwise enhance use of the document. DoD contractors, government activities, or manufacturers/vendors who are prospective suppliers of the product are invited to submit comments to the government. Fold on lines on reverse side, staple in corner, and send to preparing activity. Comments submitted on this form do not constitute or imply authorization to waive any portion of the referenced document(s) or to amend contractual requirements. Attach any pertinent data which may be of use in improving this document. If there are additional papers, attach to form and place both in an envelope addressed to preparing activity.

DOCUMENT IDENTIFIER AND TITLE

MIL-S-36957

NAME OF ORGANIZATION AND ADDRESS

CONTRACT NUMBER

MATERIAL PROCURED UNDER A

☐ DIRECT GOVERNMENT CONTRACT ☐ SUBCONTRACT

1. HAS ANY PART OF THE DOCUMENT CREATED PROBLEMS OR REQUIRED INTERPRETATION IN PROCUREMENT USE?

A. GIVE PARAGRAPH NUMBER AND WORDING.

B. RECOMMENDATIONS FOR CORRECTING THE DEFICIENCIES

2. COMMENTS ON ANY DOCUMENT REQUIREMENT CONSIDERED TOO RIGID

3. IS THE DOCUMENT RESTRICTIVE?

☐ YES ☐ NO *(If "Yes", in what way?)*

4. REMARKS

SUBMITTED BY *(Printed or typed name and address - Optional)*

TELEPHONE NO.

DATE

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